

THE THING

Big-hearted tough guy of the Fantastic Four



The radiation shields on Reed Richards' spaceship failed and pilot, Ben Grimm, was bombarded with cosmic rays.

Ben Grimm, alias The Thing is a, hot-headed member of the FANTASTIC FOUR, using his abilities to fight evil, almost as often as he does battle with himself. Ben grew up in New York City in poverty. Like his older brother, Daniel, he got involved with a street gang (see YANCY STREET GANG). After his parents died, Ben was taken in by his uncle Jake, a doctor, who helped set the boy on the right track. Ben ended up going to Empire State University on a football scholarship. His first-year roommate was brilliant science student Reed Richards, who became Ben's best friend.



Alicia Masters is Ben's true love, she loves him for himself and cares nothing for his monstrous appearance.

A GRIMM TALE

When Reed told Ben of his plan to one day build a starship, Ben jokingly said that he would pilot the ship.

After college, Ben joined the US Air Force and became an excellent pilot and astronaut. Reed's starship reached the test stage but the Federal government threatened to cut off funding, Reed decided to stage a test flight. Ben agreed to pilot the ship, though he worried that shields weren't strong enough.

Reed and Ben blasted into space along with Reed's fiancée, Susan Storm, and Sue's brother Johnny. In space, the foursome was bombarded with high levels of cosmic radiation.



The Thing battles a team of monsters led by Groot, who is able to manipulate trees and his own wood-like body.

ESSENTIAL STORYLINES

- **Fantastic Four #1** An accident in space changes pilot Ben Grimm into the orange-colored-rock-encrusted the Thing.
- **Fantastic Four #8** The Thing meets Alicia Masters and a long love affair begins.
- **Fantastic Four #310** Having quit the Fantastic Four, the Thing decides to join the West Coast Avengers, when he mutates into an even more grotesque creature, and sets off for Monster Island to find Mole Man.

LET THE CLOBBERIN' BEGIN!

The crew were altered on a genetic level and gained unusual powers. Ben's skin turned orange and rocky, and his strength grew tremendously, earning him the nickname the Thing. Reed convinced the others that they should use their powers to help humanity as the Fantastic Four. Ben would sometimes revert back to his human form unexpectedly, but neither he nor Reed could control this change. For a long time, Ben dated the blind sculptor Alicia MASTERS. Recently, though, he became engaged to Debbie Green, a teacher.

During the CIVIL WAR (see pp. 84-5), Ben became disgusted with both sides and left for France. He returned just as the conflict climaxed, working to protect innocent bystanders from any collateral damage. **MT, MF**

FACTFILE

REAL NAME

Benjamin Jacob Grimm

OCCUPATION

Adventurer, former test pilot, wrestler

BASE

New York City

HEIGHT

6 ft

WEIGHT

500 lbs

EYES

Blue

HAIR

(human form) Brown;

(the Thing) None

FIRST APPEARANCE

Fantastic Four #1

(November 1961)

Superhuman strength, endurance, and durability. He can lift 85 tons, absorb the blast of an armor-piercing bazooka shell, withstand temperature extremes, and needs no suit to survive in space or in the ocean depths.

THE THING

POWERS

